

Data science EPQ resources: pilot evaluation

Project information for teachers

Thank you for agreeing to pilot the Raspberry Pi Foundation's new data science Extended Project Qualification (EPQ) resources with your students. Alongside the pilot, we are running an evaluation, and we would like your help with it. This sheet explains what that involves, what we will do with the information you give us, and what your rights are. Please read it before the pilot begins and keep it for reference.

What is the evaluation for?

The resources are a new, self-paced course of ten units, hosted on the Ada Computer Science platform, designed to prepare Level 3 students for an independent data science project. This is the first time these resources have been used in schools and colleges.

We want to find out three things:

- Whether students engage with the course and complete it
- Whether it helps them build the skills, understanding, and confidence they need for their EPQ
- How the resources and the platform can be improved

Your experience as a teacher is central to all three, particularly because many teachers supporting a data science EPQ are not subject specialists.

Why have I been invited?

You are one of a small group of teachers who volunteered to pilot the resources between September and December 2026 with students who are due to submit their EPQ by May 2027. We are inviting every pilot teacher to take part in the evaluation.

What will I be asked to do?

Most of what we are asking for is already part of running the pilot. The evaluation adds a short weekly form and one survey.

When	What we would like you to do	Roughly how long
September 2026	Ask your students to create an Ada Computer Science account and join your cohort, so that we can identify pilot students in the platform data. Encourage them to complete the student baseline survey.	30 minutes
Weekly, September to December 2026	Run a support session for your students on the pilot.	As you would normally
Weekly, September to December 2026	Complete a short online reflection form before each weekly call: which unit you are reflecting on, what worked well, what could be better, any other comments.	5 minutes
Weekly, September to December 2026	Join the weekly webinar with the Raspberry Pi Foundation team, where we discuss the feedback received that week.	30 to 60 minutes

When	What we would like you to do	Roughly how long
December 2026	Complete a survey about your own knowledge and confidence, the difference you think the resources made to your students, and whether the course has led to other data science teaching.	15 minutes
December 2026 and April 2027	Email your students a link to the student surveys, to help us hear from students who did not finish the course.	10 minutes
June or July 2027	Nominate students who might take part in a focus group after their exams.	10 minutes

What will my students be asked to do?

Students work through the ten units and answer short self-reflection confidence questions as they go. We invite them to complete three short surveys (in September 2026, December 2026, and April 2027), and some may be invited to a focus group after their exams in summer 2027. We will look at their activity on the Ada CS platform: when they log in, which pages they view, and how many practice questions they attempt.

Students receive their own information sheet and give their own consent. Taking part is voluntary for them, and it does not affect their EPQ. The EPQ is assessed by your centre and awarding organisation, and nobody at the Raspberry Pi Foundation has any role in that.

Do I have to take part?

By signing up to take part in the pilot you are agreeing to take part in the evaluation. Your feedback is essential to helping us develop and improve the resources.

What information will be collected about me?

We will hold:

- Your name, school or college, and email address, so that we can run the pilot and contact you
- Your answers to the weekly reflection forms and the December survey (hosted on Alchemer)
- Notes from the weekly calls, recording the points discussed

We are not asking for anything about you beyond this, and we do not need any information about individual students from you.

Will I be identifiable?

We will not use your name, your school's name, or your students' names in anything we publish. Any quotations will be reported without attribution.

Your answers to the weekly and December surveys will be anonymous. However, given the small cohort of teachers taking part, it may be possible to recognise comments from the surveys in the weekly calls.

How will my information be used?

Your responses will be used by the Raspberry Pi Foundation to improve the resources and to decide whether and how to offer them more widely. They are also shared with the University of Cambridge, our partner on the Ada Computer Science platform, for research purposes.

We will publish an interim report in January 2027 and a final report in summer 2027, along with a blog post, articles in outlets such as Hello World, and possibly academic papers. Your information is

stored securely, kept only as long as we need it for the evaluation, and never sold or used for advertising.

The Ada Computer Science privacy policy explains in full how information on the platform is handled: <https://adacomputerscience.org/privacy>.

Your rights

- You can take part in the pilot, or not, and change your mind at any time.
- You can ask us what information we hold about you and get a copy of it.
- You can ask us to correct anything that is wrong or delete information we hold about you.
- If you ask us to delete your responses, we will do so, unless they have already been combined into an anonymous summary from which they cannot be separated, which will normally occur about a week after a survey has closed.
- If you are unhappy with how we have handled your information, please tell us first. You can also complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at ico.org.uk.

Questions or concerns

Please contact Ben Durbin, Head of Impact, at ben.durbin@raspberrypi.org.